
TMJ and Jaw Tension

Companion Workbook — fill it in as you go

NATE RATCLIFF, LMT

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HEALING HANDS BY NATE

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Continuity Member Edition — Month 7 Workbook

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Introduction

A PRINTABLE COMPANION TO THE MONTH 7
module. Fill it in as you go.

CHAPTER 1

How to use this workbook

PRINT IT. KEEP IT SOMEWHERE YOU'LL SEE IT — bathroom mirror, desk, kitchen counter. Fill it in over the next 7 days.

The whole point is to make conscious what's currently unconscious. You can't release jaw tension you don't know you're holding. This workbook trains you to notice.

Bring it to your next session.

CHAPTER 2

Where You Are Today

BEFORE YOU START THE PRACTICE, TAKE 5 minutes to assess honestly. No grading. Just data.

Right now, do this check:

- Are your teeth touching? [Yes / No]
- Is your tongue on the roof of your mouth? [Yes / No]
- Are your lips closed? [Yes / No]
- Are your shoulders dropped (not creeping toward your ears)? [Yes / No]

Rate each symptom (0 = none, 10 = severe):

Morning jaw soreness	[____]
Headaches at the temples	[____]
Headaches at the base of the skull	[____]
Jaw clicking or popping	[____]
Tooth sensitivity or wear	[____]
Tired face by afternoon	[____]
Neck pain (specifically upper neck)	[____]
Trouble opening mouth wide	[____]
Ear fullness or ringing	[____]

Have you ever been told you grind your teeth at night? [Yes / No / Not sure]

Do you currently wear a night guard? [Yes / No]

Three honest sentences about how your face feels right now:

1.

2.

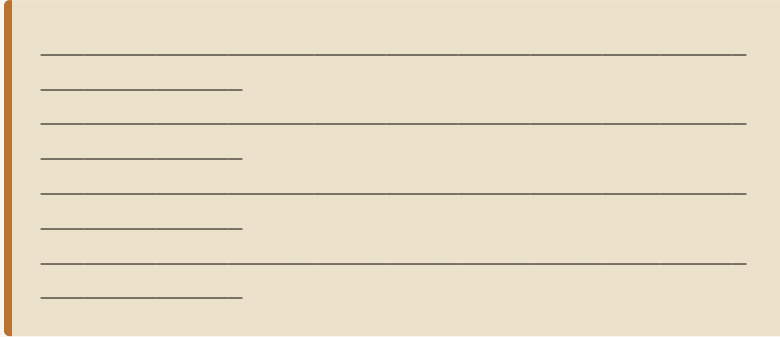
3.

CHAPTER 3

Reflection Prompts

ANSWER WITH WHATEVER COMES TO MIND FIRST.

Prompt 1: When during your day do you notice your jaw clenching the most? What's usually happening — work stress, driving, scrolling, sleep?



A light beige rectangular box with a vertical brown line on the left side, containing eight horizontal lines for writing.

Prompt 2: If you had to guess where your jaw tension comes from — physical pattern (chewing one side, sleeping on stomach), emotional pattern (work pressure, swallowing words), or both — what's your honest read?

Prompt 3: What would it feel like to actually go through a whole day without your teeth touching unless you were eating? Have you ever experienced that?

CHAPTER 4

7-Day Clench-Check Tracker

FOR THE NEXT WEEK, SET THREE REMINDERS ON your phone — morning, midday, evening. At each reminder, do a 30-second face check and mark below.

Check pattern (use for each daily entry)

At each check, ask: 1. Were my teeth touching when the reminder went off? (Y/N) 2. Where else am I bracing? Circle: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath 3. Did I do the 10-min reset today? (Y/N) 4. Headaches today? Rate 0-10.

Day 1 — Date: ____

Morning: Teeth touching? [☐] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

Midday: Teeth touching? [☐] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

Evening: Teeth touching? [☐] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

10-min reset done? [] / **Headaches today (0-10):** []

Day 2 — Date: _____

Morning: Teeth touching? [] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

Midday: Teeth touching? [] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

Evening: Teeth touching? [] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

10-min reset done? [] / **Headaches today (0-10):** []

Day 3 — Date: _____

Morning: Teeth touching? [] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

Midday: Teeth touching? [] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

Evening: Teeth touching? [] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

10-min reset done? [] / **Headaches today (0-10):** []

Day 4 — Date: _____

Morning: Teeth touching? [☐] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

Midday: Teeth touching? [☐] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

Evening: Teeth touching? [☐] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

10-min reset done? [☐] / **Headaches today (0-10):** []

Day 5 — Date: _____

Morning: Teeth touching? [☐] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

Midday: Teeth touching? [☐] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

Evening: Teeth touching? [☐] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

10-min reset done? [☐] / **Headaches today (0-10):** []

Day 6 — Date: _____

Morning: Teeth touching? [☐] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

Midday: Teeth touching? [☐] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

Evening: Teeth touching? [☐] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

10-min reset done? [☐] / **Headaches today (0-10):** []

Day 7 — Date: _____

Morning: Teeth touching? [☐] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

Midday: Teeth touching? [☐] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

Evening: Teeth touching? [☐] / Bracing: shoulders / forehead / hands / stomach / breath

10-min reset done? [☐] / **Headaches today (0-10):** []

CHAPTER 5

End-of-Week Reflection

AFTER YOUR 7 DAYS, LOOK BACK AT WHAT YOU wrote.

Re-rate each symptom (0-10):

Morning jaw soreness	[____]	(Day
1: [____])		
Headaches at the temples	[____]	(Day
1: [____])		
Headaches at base of skull	[____]	(Day
1: [____])		
Jaw clicking or popping	[____]	(Day
1: [____])		
Tired face by afternoon	[____]	(Day
1: [____])		
Neck pain (upper)	[____]	(Day
1: [____])		

What changed?

Which check time caught you clenching the most?

- ☐ Morning
- ☐ Midday
- ☐ Evening

That tells you something. What's happening at that time of day?

Which release technique worked best for you?

- ☐ External masseter release
- ☐ Temporalis release
- ☐ Jaw mobility sequence
- ☐ Resting position practice (lips together, teeth apart, tongue up)

One commitment for next week:

I will

CHAPTER 6

Try this for 7 days

IF YOU DO NOTHING ELSE FROM THIS WORKBOOK, try this:

Three jaw check-ins per day. 30 seconds each. Morning, midday, evening. Just notice if your teeth are touching, and if they are, drop the jaw. Tongue to roof of mouth. Three breaths.

That's the whole assignment. Don't add the releases. Don't add the mobility. Just notice and reset. Three times a day for one week.

Most people are stunned by how often they catch themselves clenched once they actually look. That awareness is half the fix.

Bring this workbook to your next session. Show me what you noticed.

— Nate



This book was crafted by Nate Ratcliff,
LMT and published by Healing Hands By
Nate.